to create a forest. Afforestation helps us to create the forests differently from natural forests.



Figure 22.5 Afforestation programme

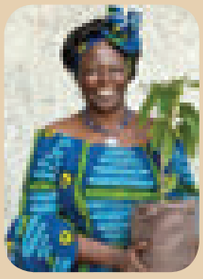
22.2.1 Importance of Afforestation

The world is experiencing a great change in the climate in the recent years than ever before. These changes in the climate have given an alarming signal to everyone. To protect our planet earth, afforestation would be a better solution. Importance of afforesatation is given below.

- Afforestation helps the wild animals and even humans to have shelter and to find their food source.
- Through afforestation we can increase the supply of oxygen. Trees planted can increase the water vapour in the atmosphere to get the rainfall.
- By planting trees the amount of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere can be reduced and thus the effects of air pollution, green house gases and global warming can be controlled.
- Afforestation enables us to avoid desertification of land.



Wangari Maathai founded the Green Belt Movement in Kenya in the year 1977. GBM has planted over 51 million trees in Kenya. She was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize for 2004.



- Barren lands experience strong winds and it causes soil erosion. Top soil is washed away during rainfall. Afforestation helps to grow more trees so that they can hold the top soil along with the nutrients.
- Creating forests provides us fodder, fruits, firewood and many other resources.
- Industries need specific type of trees. Afforestation helps us to grow a particular type of trees.

Activity 2

Discuss about afforestation in the class and write a brief report on your discussion.

22.3 Reforestation

Reforestation is the natural or intentional replanting of the existing forests that have been destroyed through deforestation. Reforestation may sound similar to afforestation but both of them are not same. Reforestation is replanting of trees in a land area which had lost its forest cover for some reason. But afforestation is growing forest in an area which originally had no tree cover. Reforestation is an effective strategy to fight global warming. In addition to benefiting the climate, reforestation helps in protecting important species of animals. Reforestation helps to rebuild habitat loss and degradation which are the leading threats to the health and endangerment of species.

Activity 3

Observe the important days related to conservation of nature. Also organise a ralley on protecting forest.

22.3.1 Importance of Reforestation

Both afforestation and reforestation are important for protecting the habitat, increasing the supply of forest products,

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